

NATWEST INTERN INTERVIEW EXPERIENCE

ABOUT NATWEST :

NatWest Group plc, headquartered in Edinburgh, Scotland, is one of the leading banking and financial services organizations in the United Kingdom. Established in 1968 through the merger of National Provincial Bank and Westminster Bank, NatWest has grown to offer a wide range of services including retail banking, commercial and business banking, private banking, and wealth management. Known for its strong digital presence and customer-focused approach, the bank provides innovative mobile and online solutions while also emphasizing sustainability by committing to achieve net zero climate impact by 2050. With its long history, strong brand recognition, and dedication to responsible banking, NatWest plays a major role in the UK's financial sector.

POSITION : Software Engineering Intern

SELECTION PROCESS :

- **Step 1** : Qualify preliminary criteria
- **Step 2** : Online Test
- **Step 3** : Competency based Interview

1. PRELIMINARY CRITERIA

- Degree : BTech (Intern)
- Branches eligible : Computer Science, Information Technology, Electronics & Communication Engineering, Electrical & Electronics, Mathematics & Computing, Mathematics & instrumentation
- Xth : minimum 70%
- XIIth : minimum 70%
- Grad : minimum 65% aggregate as per the recent mark sheet / semester.

2. ONLINE ASSESMENT

It consists of the following sections:

1. **Verbal Aptitude (15 mins)**
This section includes reading comprehension, identifying the correct tense form, and synonyms and antonyms. If you are good at grammar, you can clear this with ease.
2. **General Aptitude (30–40 mins)**
This section covers:

- Representing given data in a pie chart
- Pattern finding
- Logical thinking
- Calendar scheduling
- Profit and loss problems
- Percentages

The interface showed the number of questions solved and unsolved in one corner for this section, but I wasn't focusing on it. Because of this, I wasn't sure how many questions I had attempted or left unanswered, and I couldn't complete all of them within the given time.

PS: Don't forget to carry a calculator.

3. Technical MCQs (15 mins)

This section mainly focuses on SQL and Database concepts. Some questions were based on choosing the correct query, while others tested SQL fundamentals. If you are thorough with SQL basics, this part will be manageable.

4. Coding Questions (30 mins)

I was given two simple scenario-based questions on strings:

- Finding the count of consonants
- Returning a string with no vowels

Basic coding knowledge is enough to crack this section.

I believe the General Aptitude section carried more weightage in this round, as many of us performed on a similar level in the other three sections.

From this round, **23 of us were shortlisted** for the interview.

3. TECHNICAL AND HR INTERVIEW : (25-30 mins)

The interview was scheduled the next day after the announcement of shortlisted candidates. We first attended the PPT session, which was followed by the interview. The panel consisted of two interviewers, and the discussion mainly revolved around my resume. Both interviewers had a copy of it.

Introduction

They began by asking if I would like to introduce myself. Never miss this opportunity if given, because you can guide the interviewers about yourself. A short and crisp introduction that defines you always makes a strong impression.

Projects

They started with my projects and asked me to explain one of the projects mentioned in my resume.

Technical Questions

Before diving into the details, I had mentioned the following technical skills in my resume:

1. Programming Language – Java
2. Database Management – SQL

3. Core Concepts – Data Structures and Algorithms

They asked me how strong I was in SQL, and I confidently said I was pretty strong. I was then asked to write queries for two moderately difficult problems involving **JOINS, UNIONS, and AGGREGATE FUNCTIONS**. For the second one, I made a small syntactical mistake, which I realized only after handing over the paper. However, I understood that *‘what matters is not just what you write on paper, but how clearly you explain your approach’*. My explanation greatly convinced them, and they moved on to test my programming knowledge.

When asked which language I was most comfortable with, I answered Java. They gave me a problem:

Given an array of Strings, retrieve unique strings that do not have all letters in lowercase.

I first suggested using a **Set collection**, but they added that the result should be ordered. I then answered that I would use a **List** and check on each update, but they expected me to use a **LinkedHashSet**, which I wasn't aware of at that time. On realizing this, they asked me to explain my approach using a List. Here, they were testing how well I knew the language, since they repeatedly asked me about built-in functions to support my explanation.

Later, they asked me to explain a sorting algorithm of my choice. I chose **Merge Sort** and explained what it is, why it is used, its time and space complexities, and also drew its working process. They were particularly interested in checking whether I truly understood the concept or had just memorized it.

With this, the technical interview came to an end.

HR Questions

Next, they asked me how I would handle team conflicts. I struggled a bit to put it into words but made sure my answer reflected honesty and my willingness to handle situations positively. I also related it to my experiences working in projects and clubs.

At the end, they asked if I had any questions for them. This step is as important as your self-introduction—it's always good to ask thoughtful questions that show you are genuinely interested in the role.

(For some panels, candidates were also asked DSA problems and puzzles.)

The results were announced the same evening. Out of the shortlisted candidates, nine were selected for the internship, and I am truly grateful to be one among them.

PERSONAL TIPS :

- Make it a habit to practice DSA regularly. I would recommend choosing at least **1 DSA problem + 1 SQL problem** each day, with the difficulty level adjusted to your schedule. Practice coding on platforms like **LeetCode, HackerRank, and GeeksforGeeks**.
- Also practice aptitudes on platforms like IndiaBIX.
- Also, be comfortable coding from scratch, since some companies may ask you to write code starting from the *main* function itself.
- During interviews, maintain good body language and avoid panicking, as it creates a positive impression. Always stay optimistic, greet the interviewers, and acknowledge them at the right moments—this leaves a lasting impact.

- Before your interview, go through **GeeksforGeeks archives, CSEA or other placement experiences** to get a clearer idea of what to expect. Keep in mind that not all interviewers will be friendly or make it easy for you; some might intentionally test how you handle pressure, similar to dealing with difficult clients.
- Do thorough research on the company beforehand—it shows genuine interest in the role and will definitely work in your favor.
- Be honest about everything you have mentioned in your resume. As you can see from my experience, my interview was almost entirely tailored to what I had listed in mine.
- Most importantly, don't lose hope if you don't get through a particular company—the best is yet to come.
- Avoid self-doubt. Remember, all candidates are at a similar level. Confidence and presenting the best version of yourself is already **halfway to success**.

Best wishes!!

Feel free to contact me at any point in your preparation.

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